

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience in property law matters, file management and client communication. Supported leasehold, landlord and tenant and rights of light disputes at BCLP, where I prepared court materials and maintained structured matter records across competing deadlines. Currently advising clients on housing and related matters at Citizens Advice East Berkshire, drafting correspondence, managing case files and translating procedural requirements into clear guidance for clients in vulnerable circumstances. Experienced in reviewing documentation, preparing bundles, liaising with clients and third parties, and managing matters from instruction to conclusion.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules covering dispute resolution, procedural law, evidence analysis and legal research
- Transnational Law and Governance Applied module — 75%
- Dissertation: data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions

Law LLB — 2:1

Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules included Commercial Law, Company Law, Advanced Contract Law and Alternative Dispute Resolution

International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations

Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

July 2026 – Present

Legal Adviser

- Advises clients on housing, welfare benefits, employment, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies legal and evidential issues
- Manages matters from instruction to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Assesses eligibility against statutory criteria, identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points of law
- Translates procedural requirements into clear, practical guidance for clients in vulnerable circumstances

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation across leasehold, landlord and tenant, rights of light and easement matters: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on property law issues including rights of light, easements and leasehold disputes
- Prepared client notes and maintained matter records on iManage across several files with competing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across multiple concurrent matters

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London

Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence, drafted procedural orders and procedural histories, and amended sections of the Claimant's memorial
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout
- Liaised with the client on required documents and coordinated external translations with a Romanian translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter, under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations and identified legal and compliance risks arising from the client's data processing practices
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with client and supervising solicitor to meet deadline

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; document review and analysis; electronic bundling; concise report and correspondence writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems

Case and evidence management: File management from instruction to completion; hearing bundle preparation; procedural histories; case-file organisation; deadline tracking across concurrent matters